

PYQ-Calibrated Final Retrieval & Audit

Lesson 58 — Mixed Retrieval at Exam Depth

JKSSB Computer Awareness

October 8, 2026

Why This Capstone Exists

- ▶ This is the **exam-eve** lesson: mixed retrieval across all units at the real JKSSB depth.
- ▶ Depth held across the drill set: **50% L1** direct recall, **35% L2** contrast and classification, **15% L3** one-step application.
- ▶ Every item format JKSSB uses appears here: NOT/EXCEPT, near-neighbour, abbreviation, statement-evaluation, matching, and assertion-reason.
- ▶ Method first, facts second: **audit the stem**, then retrieve the fact.

The one rule

Read the stem twice, name the format, then answer. Format errors cost more marks than fact errors.

The Six JKSSB Item Formats

Format	What the stem looks like
NOT / EXCEPT	“Which is NOT ...” — three options true, one false
Near-neighbour	Two confusable terms side by side (RAM/ROM, POP3/IMAP)
Abbreviation	Expand the short form, or name the short form
Statement-evaluation	Statements I/II/III; pick the correct combination
Matching	Match List I with List II, or pick the correct pairing
Assertion–reason	Assertion (A) + Reason (R); judge each, then the link

Each format has its own attack below. Never answer before naming it.

Format 1: NOT / EXCEPT Items

- ▶ Circle the word **NOT**, **EXCEPT**, or **incorrect** before reading the options.
- ▶ Mark each option **True** or **False** in the margin; the odd one out is the answer.
- ▶ Trap: the three true options are all attractive. Do not pick the first true statement you see.

Worked mini-example [*Original*], pattern after PYQ-03

Which is NOT true of cache memory? A. Holds recent data (true). B. Faster than RAM (true). C. Permanent backup of RAM (false). D. Exploits locality (true).
Answer: **C** — cache holds copies, not a backup.

Format 2: Near-Neighbour Distractors

- ▶ For every key term, retrieve the triple: **what it is / what it is not / nearest confusion**.
- ▶ Classic pairs: RAM vs ROM, POP3 vs IMAP, Section Break vs Page Break, signature vs encryption, MICR vs OCR vs OMR.
- ▶ Read **both** words of the pair; the examiner swaps exactly one.

Worked mini-example [*Original*], pattern after TRAP-15

“A digital signature encrypts the mail body so only the recipient can read it.” Wrong: signature gives **authenticity and integrity**; **encryption** gives confidentiality. One verb swapped, whole item flips.

Format 3: Abbreviation and Shortcut Items

- ▶ Give the **full form on first sight**: POP3 — Post Office Protocol version 3; ISP — Internet Service Provider.
- ▶ Shortcuts are exact: **F5** starts the slide show from the beginning; **F7** is spell check; a formula starts with **=**.
- ▶ Near-neighbours here are single-letter swaps: IMAP vs IMAC, POP3 vs SMTP. Spell the abbreviation out loud.

Worked mini-example [*Original*], pattern after PYQ-34

Expand ISP. A. Internet Service Provider (correct). B. Intranet System Program. C. Internet Server Process. D. Internal Service Protocol. Only **A** matches the exact exam wording.

Format 4: Statement-Evaluation (I/II/III)

- ▶ Judge **each statement alone** first: write T or F beside I, II, III.
- ▶ Then keep only the option whose combination matches your T/F pattern.
- ▶ Trap: one false statement hides inside two true ones (often the RAM-volatility or PC-address claim).

Worked mini-example [*Original*], pattern after PYQ-03/PYQ-04

I. Registers are fastest (T). II. Cache is faster than RAM (T). III. RAM is non-volatile (F). Correct combination: **I and II only**.

Format 5: Matching Items

- ▶ Match what you **know first**: lock one certain pair, strike out every option that breaks it.
- ▶ Device drills decide these: plotter is output, scanner is input, MICR reads magnetic ink, BIOS boots the machine.
- ▶ If two options survive, compare only the pairs that differ.

Worked mini-example [*Original*], pattern after PYQ-08

Which pairing is correct? A. Plotter — input (wrong). B. Scanner — output (wrong). C. MICR — magnetic ink characters (correct). D. Sound card — input (wrong).

Answer: **C**.

Format 6: Assertion–Reason Items

- ▶ Step 1: judge (A) alone. Step 2: judge (R) alone. Step 3: ask whether (R) **explains** (A) — not merely whether both are true.
- ▶ Both-true-but-unlinked is the standard trap; do not pick the “explains” option unless the link is direct.

Worked mini-example [*Original*], pattern after PYQ-18

(A) IPv6 uses 128-bit addresses. (R) HTTP/3 runs over QUIC, not TCP. Both true, but (R) does not explain (A). Answer: **both true, (R) is not the explanation of (A)**.

The Negative-Stem Audit Method

- ▶ Step 1: **underline** NOT, EXCEPT, incorrect, or CANNOT in the stem.
- ▶ Step 2: convert the stem to positive: “find the three true statements, the leftover wins.”
- ▶ Step 3: test every option with a T/F mark; pick the single **False** one.
- ▶ Step 4: re-read the stem once more before marking the OMR — confirm you answered the negative question.

Why this matters

With a $-1/4$ **penalty** per wrong answer, one misread NOT-stem costs the mark plus the penalty. Blank scores zero; a guess after eliminating two options is the only gamble worth taking.

The Defective-Option Audit Method

- ▶ Some official options are **defective**: loose wording the final key may not sustain. Quote them verbatim, flag them, and learn the stable concept instead.
- ▶ Defect 1, quoted verbatim: “Program Counter stores the address of the **current** instruction being executed.” **Flag**: the PC holds the address of the **next** instruction to fetch (TRAP-04).
- ▶ Defect 2, quoted verbatim (option wording): “BCC hides sender and recipients from **each other**.” **Flag**: BCC hides recipients from **each other**; the sender always knows, and To/Cc stay visible to all (TRAP-16).

Stable concepts to carry

PC = next instruction. BCC = recipients hidden from each other only. The final key (Tier 1) always wins over any single option's wording.

Answer-Rationale Rules

- ▶ Every answer needs two halves: **why the key is right** and **why each distractor is wrong**.
- ▶ Name the trap each distractor instantiates (e.g. “reverses RAM/ROM,” “swaps Section/Page Break,” “states 256-bit IPv6”).
- ▶ Keep exam wording exact: full forms, shortcut keys, command spellings, and protocol names verbatim.
- ▶ One fact per line; never invent a paper number, page, or key date.

Rationale template

Correct option + one-line authority. Then, per distractor: what it claims, which trap it matches, and the one-line correction.

Time and Penalty Discipline

- ▶ Junior Assistant and Website Operator papers: **80 items, 80 minutes, $-1/4$ per wrong answer**. Roughly one minute per item.
- ▶ First pass: answer every **L1 recall** item immediately; mark the rest.
- ▶ Second pass: L2 classification and matching with the T/F margin marks.
- ▶ Third pass: L3 scenarios only. **Blank** beats a blind guess; guess only after eliminating at least two options.

Quick-Hit Rail: Units 1–6

- ▶ U1 Fundamentals: bit smallest; $10 = 1010_2$; ICs = third generation; BCD = 4 bits per digit.
- ▶ U2 CPU: PC = next instruction; interrupts at instruction boundaries; overflow is not carry-out; diagnose the stated bottleneck.
- ▶ U3 Memory: RAM volatile, ROM non-volatile; cache faster than RAM; CPU never touches secondary storage directly.
- ▶ U4 I/O: plotter/printer/sound card = output; scanner/light pen/ digitizer = input; MICR = magnetic ink; Section Break changes headers/footers.
- ▶ U5 Software/OS: driver is software; OS is system software; BIOS boots; open-source = view/change/share.
- ▶ U6 Programming: compiler vs interpreter; stack is LIFO; algorithm before code.

Quick-Hit Rail: Units 7–11

- ▶ U7 Office: formula starts with =; F5 from beginning, F7 spell check; Mail Merge = letters + database; Select query retrieves.
- ▶ U8 Internet/Email: @ separates user name and domain; POP3 downloads, IMAP syncs; ISP = Internet Service Provider.
- ▶ U9 Networking: IPv6 = 128-bit; BGP is inter-domain; HTTP/3 uses QUIC over UDP; ICMP is control only.
- ▶ U10 Security: signature = authenticity, encryption = confidentiality; phishing vs ransomware vs DDoS kept distinct.
- ▶ U11 Governance: e-NAM = agricultural marketing; G2C/G2G/G2B/G2E expansions; Digital India and NeGP/e-Kranti roles.

Lesson 58: Recall

- ▶ Name the format first: NOT/EXCEPT, near-neighbour, abbreviation, statement-evaluation, matching, assertion–reason.
- ▶ Negative stems: underline NOT, mark T/F per option, re-read before marking.
- ▶ Defective options: quote verbatim, flag, and carry the stable concept (PC = next; BCC = recipients hidden from each other).
- ▶ Every rationale: why the key is right plus why each distractor is wrong, with the trap named.
- ▶ Hold the 50/35/15 depth; spend time where L2/L3 traps cluster, and respect the $-1/4$ penalty.